PERSONAL AI AGENTS LIVE · JULY 21, 2026

Using Personal AI in 2026: OpenClaw and the New Developer Workflow

A 45-minute hands-on workshop: messy discovery to PRD, PRD to issues, issues to /goal, /goal to a working app.

Brad Groux · Digital Meld · OpenClaw Maintainer

YOUR FACILITATOR

Brad Groux

Co-founder of Digital Meld, OpenClaw contributor and maintainer, and builder of practical agent workflows that end in inspectable artifacts.

Builder, operator, maintainer

OpenClaw, Digital Meld, Dev Days, and repo-backed demos.

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THE PROBLEM

One-off prompts skip the work that makes software shippable.

Context gets lost

Stakeholder nuance, constraints, source confidence, and decision history disappear between chats.

Plans stay vague

Requirements, risks, acceptance criteria, and sequencing are implied instead of written down.

Code starts early

The agent builds before the team agrees what problem the product is supposed to solve.

THE SPLIT

OpenClaw plans. Codex builds. The repo preserves the trail.

OpenClaw

- Ingests stakeholder context
- Runs the grill-with-docs loop
- Forces missing decisions into the open
- Generates the PRD contract

Codex

- Turns PRD into issue artifacts
- Creates the /goal prompt
- Implements scoped work
- Runs verification and merges PRs

FICTIONAL SCENARIO

E Corp Cyber Escalation Command Center

A fictional Mr. Robot-inspired company needs to triage recovery risks, issues, and threat signals without connecting live systems.

First useful win

Angela filters critical escalations, checks reviewed evidence, assigns an owner, and exports a concise executive brief.

SOURCE CORPUS

The demo starts with business context, not code.

Docs

Company brief, stakeholder brief, discovery transcript, systems, people, and signals.

Comms

Fabricated emails, memos, and chat excerpts that create realistic ambiguity.

Safety

No private records, no live accounts, no credentials, no sends, no operational attack steps.

$GRILL-WITH-DOCS

The planning loop makes the hidden decisions explicit.

Users
Who triages, who decides, who reviews evidence, and who needs the brief?

Scope
What belongs in the first local app, and what stays out?

Safety
What must remain draft-only, fictional, reviewed, and local?

Proof
What would prove the workflow worked by the end of the workshop?

THE CONTRACT

The PRD becomes the handoff point.

It names the app, product output, presentation output, non-goals, app requirements, safety requirements, and acceptance criteria.

```
PRD.md
Problem
Goal
Product Output
Presentation Output
App Requirements
Safety Requirements
Acceptance Criteria
```

ISSUE ARTIFACTS

The PRD turns into scoped implementation work.

Data and shell

Seed JSON, static app files, and five-tab structure.

Workflow views

Queue, evidence feed, executive brief, fabricated repo, and Build Trace.

Handoff

Slides, PDF, speaker notes, smoke checks, and repo audit.

IMPLEMENTATION START

/goal is the durable start line.

It carries the PRD, issue artifacts, source corpus, app spec, ordering, safety boundary, and verification gates into the build loop.

```
/goal Build the E Corp Cyber Escalation
Command Center static app.

Read:
- PRD.md
- app-output-spec.md
- issue-artifacts.md
- source-corpus/

Verify:
- all tabs render
- filters and local state work
- export and reset work
```

THE ARTIFACT

A local command center, not a static report.

The app runs from local HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and JSON. It filters, edits local state, marks evidence reviewed, exports JSON, and resets cleanly.

PROOF

The Build Trace shows the artifact chain.

Corpus
Briefs, transcript, comms, signals.

Grill
Questions force scope and safety decisions.

PRD
Requirements become the contract.

Issues
Work becomes scoped and reviewable.

/goal
The build loop starts with context.

App
Local command center output.

Export
State is reviewable JSON.

RECREATE IT

The repo documents the steps so attendees can run the pattern later.

Run the path

- Read the packet README
- Open the prompt pack
- Use the checked-in corpus if live generation is slow
- Start from the saved /goal prompt

Fallback cleanly

- Use the full corpus
- Use the implementation plan
- Use the finished app as proof
- Keep external action manual

CALL TO ACTION

Pick one messy workflow and turn it into a durable artifact chain.

Do not start with automation. Start with context, a PRD, scoped issues, a /goal prompt, and verification that proves the result.

Fork the packet

Replace the E Corp corpus with your own safe public or synthetic business context.

Run the grill

Use OpenClaw to force scope, safety, users, and proof into the PRD.

Ship one artifact

Use Codex to build the smallest inspectable app, report, or workflow that proves the method.

FOLLOW-UP

Start with a bounded workflow and leave a trail.

Use the repo packet, OpenClaw docs, and Discord to recreate the workflow after the event.

- github.com/openclaw/openclaw
- docs.openclaw.ai
- github.com/BradGroux/openclaw-dev-days
- where.bradgroux.com

Join the OpenClaw Discord

discord.com/invite/clawd